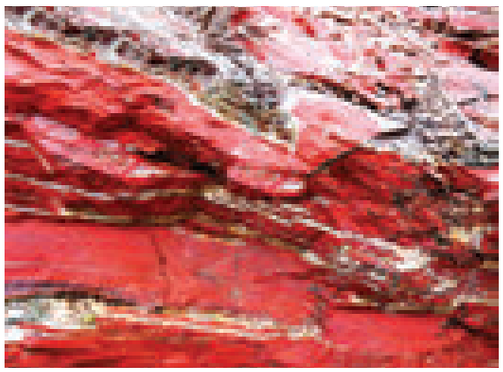
One of the world wonders Taj Mahal in India was built with White Marbles a metamorphic rock.



Metamorphic Rock

Formation of Metamorphic Rocks from Igneous rocks

1. Granite into gneiss caused by dynamic metamorphism.
2. Basalt into slate caused by thermal metamorphism.

Formation of Metamorphic Rocks from Sedimentary rocks

1. Sandstone into quartz caused by thermal metamorphism.
2. Shale into slate caused by thermal metamorphism.

Characteristics of Metamorphic Rocks

1. Metamorphic rocks are mostly crystalline in nature.
2. They consist of alternate bands of light and dark minerals.

Rock cycle

Igneous rocks are the primary rocks formed first on the earth. These rocks are weathered, eroded, transported and deposited at some places to form sedimentary rocks. The Igneous and Sedimentary rocks are changed into metamorphic rocks under the influence of temperature and pressure. The metamorphic rocks are also get disintegrated and deposited to form sedimentary rocks. Formation of igneous rocks take place when there is an outflow of molten materials. Like this, the rocks of the earth crust keeps on changing from one form to another form under various natural forces and agents. The endless process is referred as **Rock Cycle**.

Quartzite and Marble are the rocks commonly used for construction and sculpture works. Marbles are widely used for making beautiful statues and decorative items such as vase, tiny gift articles and grinded marble is used to produce plastics, paper etc.,

Uses of rocks

Rocks have been used by mankind throughout the history. Rocks are highly valuable and important to almost all aspects of our economy. The minerals and metals in rocks have been found essential to human civilization. Rocks are used for many purposes in our life and some of them are given below

Rocks are useful for making

1. Cement
2. Writing chalk
3. Fire
4. Building materials
5. Bath scrub
6. Kerb stone
7. Ornament
8. Roofing materials
9. Decorative materials
10. These are valuable source of minerals such as gold, diamond, sapphire etc.

ACTIVITY

Collect different types of rocks and display them in the class room

TN_GOVT_VIII_Std_Geography_Unit I_updated.indd 88 2/21/2020 10:31:37 AM